

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 2 of 6

THE PLAYLIST LESSON

What's in the Playlist?

Gap in the playlist, **gap in the AI.**

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Playlist Check



Name: _____ Partner: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You are the AI. The playlist below is your **training data** — every song you have ever "heard." Work in pairs. **Partner A is the App:** you pick the song. **Partner B is the Request Line:** you read each request out loud, like a caller on a radio show. Swap jobs after request #3. To **serve** a song means to pick a card and hand it over. Three rules:

- **Rule 1:** Only serve cards from the playlist. No inventing songs mid-game.
- **Rule 2:** Never say no. Serve the closest card you've got — a music app always gives you *something*.
- **Rule 3:** Tick the Fit box honestly, on your own sheet. The ticks are the data.

THE PLAYLIST — ALL 12 SONGS YOU KNOW

Thunder Mode Hype Trap · Fast · Party	Bass Quake Electro Party · Fast · Party	Level Up Anthem Hype Trap · Fast · Gym	Full On Hype Hype Trap · Fast · Sports
Neon Stampede Electro Party · Fast · Party	Turbo Turbo Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Crowd Goes Wild Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports	Volume War Hype Trap · Fast · Party
Midnight Sprint Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Glow Up Tonight Party Pop · Fast · Party	Party Cannon Party Pop · Fast · Party	Cool Down (Kinda) Party Pop · Medium · Party

Hype = loud and exciting. Cut the cards apart, or just use them as-is. Notice anything about this playlist yet? Keep that idea for later.

SERVE THE REQUEST LINE

Request Line reads it. App serves the best card. Both of you write the card and tick ONE Fit box on your own sheet.

REQUEST	BEST CARD IN YOUR PLAYLIST	PERFECT FIT	KIND OF FITS	NOTHING FITS
1. You need a hype song for when the basketball team runs onto the court.		☐	☐	☐
2. Nia wants something calm to study to before the math test.		☐	☐	☐
3. Tomás wants a song in Spanish for his abuela's (grandma's) birthday dinner.		☐	☐	☐
4. Keisha wants a slow song for the last dance at the 8th-grade dance. (Swap jobs first!)		☐	☐	☐
5. Malik wants a first song for his party — one that makes everyone jump at once.		☐	☐	☐
6. Jordan wants a quiet guitar song for the talent-show sing-along.		☐	☐	☐
7. Live request from another pair: _____		☐	☐	☐

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key



What's in the Playlist? — AutoMix improv tips, a key or exemplar for every Playlist Check item, the real-world debrief, what-ifs, standards.

WHY THIS LESSON

Students usually hear "AI is biased" as "somebody made it mean." This lesson swaps the villain for a mechanism: **input** → **patterns** → **output**. Once a student has personally failed Tomás because their playlist held no Spanish tracks, "biased training data" stops being vocabulary and becomes something they *did* — and can fix. Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it, the AI does the middle from its playlist, and a person checks what comes back. A gap in the playlist is why that last human has to check.

PLAYING THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP

Three moves carry the bit: **serve with total confidence** (the app has no idea it's full — never apologize), **announce the track like it's exactly right** ("Grandma's birthday? VOLUME 100%"), and **upgrade nothing** — a slow-song request gets the same tempo, cheerfully. Keep it to 3–4 requests. The gold moment: a student says the playlist is the problem, not the app. Hand them the imaginary aux cord — they just said the thesis out loud.

ANSWER KEY — SERVE THE REQUEST LINE (WORKSHEET P.1)

"Best card" can vary; the **Fit ticks** shouldn't drift far from these (scale: **Perfect fit** · **Kind of fits** · **Nothing fits**).

REQUEST	STRONG PICKS	EXPECTED FIT
1. Priya — hyped-up song, team runs onto the field	Full Court Press, Crowd Goes Wild	Perfect fit
2. Nia — calm study music	Cool Down (Kinda)	Kind of fits, at best — medium, but still a loud party track
3. Tomás — song in Spanish	Any card (the app must serve)	Nothing fits — zero Spanish tracks
4. Keisha — slow last-dance song	Cool Down (Kinda)	Nothing fits — medium is not slow; nothing slower exists
5. Malik — first song of the party	Thunder Mode, Bass Quake, Confetti Cannon	Perfect fit
6. Jordan — quiet guitar song	Any card	Nothing fits — nothing quiet exists
7. Live request	Varies	Ask: what did the playlist do to it?

Why Cool Down (Kinda) is **Kind of fits** for Nia but **Nothing fits** for Keisha: "calm" is a mood the track half-has; "slow" is a tempo it simply isn't. If a pair ticks Nia as Nothing fits or Keisha as Kind of fits, don't correct it — ask them to defend it. The disagreement is the lesson.

THE PLAYLIST LESSON • LESSON 2 OF 6

What's in the Playlist?



A 45-minute lesson on how AI learns — and where bias comes from. The hook: an AI is a music app, its training data is the playlist, and a one-genre playlist means one-genre answers. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Playlist Check worksheet, 2 pages, 1 per student — each fills their OWN sheet (typeable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script in the notes) · board · scissors optional	None — runs fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the deck	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Explain how an AI learns: **input** → **patterns** → **output** — prediction from data, not magic. (5 min, Exit Ticket #1)
- Name who a dataset serves well and who it leaves out; link that gap to real AI bias. (Gap Report, Exit #2)
- Discuss data gaps collaboratively: repeat a partner's idea, then add to it. (Repeat When Add, Exit Ticket #3)

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-21

ISTE 1.1.d

CCSS ELA SL.6.1

Full text: Teacher Guide, p.3

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Grey sentence starters on the worksheet, landmark-card tip in the Teacher Guide, p.2.
- Extension:** Design a 12-card playlist that serves every request on the sheet, then defend the trade-offs.
- ELL:** Fit marks are tick marks; invented cards may be in any language (that fixes a real gap).
- No-device classrooms:** Built in — the lesson is paper, pairs, and one loud imaginary music app.

WORKSHEET — THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP (7 MIN)

Hook: AutoMix, the school's new music app. Your playlist holds one kind of song: loud, fast party tracks. Take 3–4 requests and serve every one with total confidence:

"Something chill to study to?" → "Here's 'TURBO TURBO.' It is not chill. It's what I've got."

"A song for grandma's birthday dinner?" → "Got it. 'VOLUME WAR.' Grandma loves bass drops, probably."

"A slow song for the last dance?" → "'NEON STAMPEDE,' played at... the exact same speed."

Then ask: **"Is AutoMix bad at picking songs — or is something else broken?"** Fish for it: the app is doing its job perfectly. The *playlist* is the problem.

If nobody gets there: "Could AutoMix play a slow song if it had one?" Yes — the app works. So what's missing?

Bridge: "(If your class did the genie lesson: it granted what you SAID.) Today: where an AI's answers even come from. Everything an AI 'knows' comes from a playlist of examples — its training data. It can remix the playlist, but it can't serve what was never in it. Today you'll BE the app."

Transition: "So what IS in an AI's playlist, and what does it do with it? Three words on the board."